

Character Dossiers ("Case Files") — design sketch v1 + Ep1 fact sets (2026-08-11, for Stephen's markup)

Stephen's pitch: a bio per character, progressively unlocked with CaseCash, each reveal carrying bible facts plus a reward; completing every dossier is the long-tail side quest. Diegetic frame: these are ALLY'S CASE FILES on the people of Havenbay — an investigator keeps dossiers; the player is reading hers.

Design

- **Entry points:** the character profile modal (evidence board polaroids) gains a DOSSIER section under "Appears in N scenes". Ally's own dossier opens from her HUD bust (currently tap-dead).

- **Structure per character:** one free intro line + 4 locked FACTS (Vera: 3 — she is deliberately a smaller file). Escalating prices **50 / 100 / 150 / 200 CC** (500 CC per full dossier).

- **Rewards:** items and Case Kit specials ONLY, themed to the character. **No energy ever** (CC→energy ban) and **no ingots in v1** (a CC→premium conversion would leak against IAP). Calibration rule: reward shop-value ≤ half the fact price — the player pays for the lore; the reward is a thank-you.

- **Spoiler gating:** each character's final fact needs `e1.phase1.complete` + episode resolution (`aq.lead.e1_close.seen`) in addition to CC — keeps case-outcome facts safe and gives dossiers life after the credits. Season-arc material (Ferryman, the truth about Thomas) NEVER appears in Ep1 dossiers.

- **Completion reward:** finishing a dossier grants that character's **Tip-Line Cassette** — their voice as a keepsake. Dot's exists today (her goodnight); Mo/Del/Gerald cassettes ride the VO recording queue; until a clip exists the completion grants the listed special and reserves the cassette slot ("tape pending" state).

- **Economy shape:** full Ep1 set = 2,800 CC. Deliberately MORE than one episode's income after shop and locker spending — completing the wall is a long-tail goal, not a day-one checkbox.

- **Persistence:** PlayerPrefs JSON (precedent: specials, shop); flagged for the eventual save-aggregate consolidation pass alongside them.

- **Analytics:** `dossier_fact_unlocked` (character, index, price, balance).

Writing rules for facts: 1–3 sentences, noir register, no em dashes, no exclamation marks, Ep1-spoiler-safe. Every line below is bible-sourced; anything that adds connective tissue beyond the bible is flagged **[INVENTION — approve/edit/cut]**.

Ep1 fact sets (the actual content, for approval)

ALLY QUINN — free intro

Host of Echoes of Havenbay. Licensed investigator. Tells the city what it won't tell itself.

#	CC	Fact	Reward
1	50	Born March 30th. An Aries, which Gerald says explains everything and excuses nothing. [INVENTION: the Gerald quip]	Coffee and Donut (food T3)
2	100	The silver locket she never takes off holds a photo of her father. Thomas Quinn wrote for the Gazette. He died when she was thirteen.	Recorder & Headphones (audio T3)
3	150	Her favourite film is Spotlight. Her favourite food is pancakes at a late-night diner. She maintains these are professional influences. [INVENTION: last line]	Box Knife (special)
4	200 · gated	The PI licence is real. She just knows that people talk to a podcaster long before they talk to an investigator.	Search Warrant (special)
✓	—	Completion: Carbon Copy + cassette slot reserved (Ally cassette TBD — her voice is the show itself; maybe the pilot episode stinger?)	

GERALD QUINN — free intro

Retired Brookford PD detective. Ally's grandfather, first reader, and favourite bad influence.

#	CC	Fact	Reward
1	50	Thirty years a detective. He taught Ally what to write down, when to shut up, and how to spot a lie.	Beer Bottle (bar T4)
2	100	The corner booth at the Rusty Anchor is held for him without asking. The older dockhands remember what kind of cop he was, and that credit extends to Ally.	Wine Glass Red (bar T5)
3	150	The teal suit and the magenta shirt are not a phase. He says a detective should be memorable to friends and forgettable to suspects, and refuses to explain further. [INVENTION: the sayings]	Bolt Cutters (special)
4	200 · gated	He checks Ally's ribs when he hugs her. Old habit. He has been inspecting her for damage since she was thirteen. [INVENTION: extends the L4 rib-check canon into a habit]	Carbon Copy (special)
✓	—	Completion: cassette slot reserved (Gerald VO pending) + Skeleton Key	

MO CALLAHAN — free intro

Owner of the Rusty Anchor. Keeper of the neutral ground and everything said across it.

#	CC	Fact	Reward
1	50	Third generation behind the bar. Patrick Callahan opened the doors in 1924; her father Seamus salvaged a shipwreck anchor, bolted it by the door, and renamed the place around it.	Tall Glass Orange (bar T3)
2	100	House rule older than she is: violence goes outside, whoever you are. Everyone trusts the rule. That is why Mo hears everything.	Champagne Flute (bar T6)
3	150	She calls exactly one person "my lovely" at a time and rations it like the good whiskey. [INVENTION: the rationing line — bible says the endearment is hers, exclusivity per person is new]	Box Knife (special)
4	200 · gated	Upstairs, behind a locked door: ledgers, old matchbooks, and a shoebox of favours owed. Mo collects debts patiently, the way the tide does. [INVENTION: the simile]	Evidence Tag (special)
✓	—	Completion: Mo cassette (VO pending) + Search Warrant	

DEL CRUZ — free intro

Sergeant, Harbor Ward precinct. Calls Ally "Quinny". Nobody else is allowed.

#	CC	Fact	Reward
1	50	The kestrel on her right wrist points home to Kestrel Point. The Saint Michael medallion hangs on its own chain, never the one with the badge.	Evidence Bag (forensic T2)
2	100	Her table outside the Kestrel Corner Diner has the best sightlines on the street. Back to the wall, eyes on the crossing and everyone's hands. Coffee makes you a friend at that table.	Hot Coffee Cup (food T2)
3	150	At twenty-three, a rookie constable, she stood on the Quinn doorstep the night Thomas died. Ally was thirteen. Del has been quietly watching out for her ever since.	Search Warrant (special)
4	200 · gated	She bends rules the way a locksmith bends wire: precisely, quietly, and only for doors that should never have been locked. [INVENTION: the whole line — a character thesis, please rule]	Skeleton Key (special)
✓	—	Completion: Del cassette (VO pending) + Bolt Cutters	

DOT ELLIS — free intro

Retired school cleaner, Rivermouth. For three years she said goodnight to the whole city, one voicemail at a time.

#	CC	Fact	Reward
1	50	Thirty years cleaning the Chandler Road school. She knows every floorboard in Rivermouth and precisely which gulls are troublemakers. [INVENTION: the gull census]	Paper Cup (food T1)
2	100	Tuesday quiz night at the Rusty Anchor, table six. She has never once missed it.	Tall Glass Orange (bar T3)
3	150	The garden behind the blue gate is the most loved thing on Chandler Road. Hollyhocks, roses, and a fence you could walk with your eyes shut.	Coffee and Donut (food T3)
4	200 · gated	She went out through the allotments and caught the first bus of the morning, and told nobody, to keep her sister out of it. Brave, dry, and allergic to fuss.	Evidence Tag (special)
✓	—	Completion: Dot's cassette — SHIPS TODAY (her goodnight voicemail already exists as a clip)	

VERA — free intro (3 facts; a deliberately thin file)

Dot's sister. Larkhill, the hill cottage. Says hello, which for Vera is a parade.

#	CC	Fact	Reward
1	50	The hill cottage above Larkhill: one kettle, two chairs, and a view worth the climb. [INVENTION: the inventory]	Hot Coffee Cup (food T2)
2	100	She and Dot speak in a shorthand fifty years deep. Half their sentences do not need finishing. [INVENTION: whole line, though it dramatizes established sisterhood]	Wine Glass Red (bar T5)
3	150 · gated	When Dot needed to disappear, Vera asked no questions. That is the entire family style.	Bolt Cutters (special)
✓	—	Completion: cassette slot reserved (Vera VO pending) + Carbon Copy	

Open rulings

- The **[INVENTION]** lines: approve, edit, or cut each (nine total).
- Reward visibility: show the reward on locked facts (collection-book style) or keep it a surprise? (Recommend: show it — it sells the unlock.)
- Final-fact gating on episode completion: confirm.
- Prices 50/100/150/200 and the no-ingots rule: confirm.
- Ally's completion cassette: what IS a cassette of the host? (Pilot stinger? Thomas's old voicemail, someday? Happy to leave slot reserved.)
- Mrs. Vale: no dossier in v1 (non-speaking). Confirm.